

# Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting in 3/4 time, featuring treble and bass staves. The key signature has four flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, D-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with three vocal parts (1, 2, 3) and a common bass line. Chord symbols are placed above the treble staff of each system. The lyrics are written below the staves, with some words hyphenated across measures.

System 1: Chords: D $\flat$ , E $\flat$ m, A $\flat$ , D $\flat$ .  
Lyrics: 1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,  
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,  
3 And since to look at things in bloom

System 2: Chords: D $\flat$ , G $\flat$ , A $\flat$ sus, A $\flat$ , D $\flat$ .  
Lyrics: hung with bloom a - long the bough,  
twen - ty will not come the a - gain.  
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

System 3: Chords: G $\flat$ , E $\flat$ m, F.  
Lyrics: it stands a - bout the wood - land ride  
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,  
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

System 4: Chords: D $\flat$ /F, Fm, E $\flat$ m, A $\flat$ , D $\flat$ .  
Lyrics: wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.  
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.  
see the cher - ry hung with snow.